This happens to be one of the most secure ways of testing new operating systems out there.

- Implement malware programs securely
  Since the activity of a VM is effectively sandboxed from the rest of your computer— and it can't access files on your host OS (unless you let it)— you can use VMs to test suspicious files that may contain viruses and other harmful software.

- If you've been a lifelong tinkerer, VMs are the ultimate tool for you to play around with your machine without any hesitations and repercussions. For example, you can play around with core Windows settings by opening Windows in a VM. As expected, this doesn't affect the host OS. This also helps you when you're learning about new systems like Linux, as there is more risk of doing something wrong on an OS you aren't used to.

- Develop applications and test them on various programs
  With a VM, you can emulate whichever OS you want, and test your application in that environment. This is especially useful for people who develop apps and games.

- Running Proprietary software
  For example: If you are using Linux, then having a Windows emulator can be really helpful, for running the few applications which run only on Windows.

Do I need special hardware to run a VM?

Although there's no piece of hardware that's specifically required for running Virtual Machines, you should have a decently powerful computer, with at least 8 GB of RAM, a relatively new CPU, and large storage capacity to be able to smoothly run your VM.

VM vs Dual Boot

Dual boot systems are computers on which two operating systems are present on the hard drive. At the time of booting, you choose which OS to run.

While in a VM, you have one OS running in a virtual server created by another OS.